

Menexenus

ΜΕΝΕΞΕΝΟΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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S: Menexenus, are you coming from the Agora, or from where?

ΣΩ. ἐξ ἀγορᾶς ἢ πόθεν Μενέξενος; ΜΕΝ. ἐξ ἀγορᾶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ ἀπὸ τοῦ βουλευτηρίου. ΣΩ. τί μάλιστα σοὶ πρὸς βουλευτήριον; ἢ δήλα δὴ ὅτι παιδεύσεως καὶ φιλοσοφίας ἐπὶ τέλει ἡγῆ εἶναι, καὶ ὡς ἱκανῶς ἤδη ἔχων ἐπὶ τὰ μείζω ἐπινοεῖς τρέπεσθαι, καὶ ἄρχειν ἡμῶν, ὦ θαυμάσιε, ἐπιχειρεῖς τῶν πρεσβυτέρων

MX: Yes, from the Agora, Socrates, from the Council Chamber in fact.

S: Why exactly were you at the Council Chamber? Or is it obvious that you think you have completed your philosophic education and intend to turn to more important subjects because you believe that you are now up to the task? My wonderful fellow, are you, at your age, turning your hand to exercising authority over us, your elders, so that your house may keep up its tradition of looking after us?

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MX: Socrates, if you allow me to assume public office and advise me to do so, I'll be eager, but not otherwise. On this occasion, I went to the Council Chamber because I found out that the Council was about to select someone to speak over the war dead. You know, of course, that they are about to arrange their funeral rites.

τηλικοῦτος ὢν, ἵνα μὴ ἐκλίπη ὑμῶν ἡ οἰκία ἀεὶ τινα ἡμῶν ἐπιμελητὴν παρεχομένη; ΜΕΝ. ἐὰν σύ γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἑᾶς καὶ συμβουλεύῃς ἄρχειν, προθυμήσομαι· εἰ δὲ μή, οὐ. νῦν μέντοι ἀφικόμην πρὸς τὸ βουλευτήριον πυθόμενος ὅτι ἡ βουλὴ μέλλει αἰρεῖσθαι ὅστις ἐρεῖ ἐπὶ τοῖς ἀποθανούσιν· ταφὰς γὰρ οἶσθ' ὅτι μέλλουσι ποιεῖν. ΣΩ. πάνυ γε· ἀλλὰ τίνα εἴλοντο; ΜΕΝ. οὐδένα, ἀλλὰ ἀνεβάλοντο εἰς τὴν αὔριον. οἶμαι μέντοι Ἀρχῖνον ἢ Δίωνα αἰρεθήσεσθαι.

S: Certainly, but whom did they select?

MX: No one, they put it off until tomorrow. However, I think that Archinus or Dion will be selected.

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S: And, indeed, Menexenus, to die in battle seems to be a noble fate in all sorts of ways. For even if someone dies in poverty, he gets a noble and magnificent burial, and he wins praise although he was an ordinary fellow, praise from wise men who do not speak at random but in speeches prepared long before. These people utter their praises so well, speaking of qualities each individual possesses and does not possess, using such splendid verbal embellishments that they enchant our souls as they praise the city in all sorts of ways, the war dead too, and our ancestors who went before us, and, indeed, ourselves who are still alive. And so, Menexenus, I myself, when praised by them, am ennobled by them, and every time I listen, spellbound, I believe there and then that I have become greater, nobler and more exalted.

ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν, ὦ Μενέξενε, πολλαχῇ κινδυνεύει καλὸν εἶναι τὸ ἐν πολέμῳ ἀποθνήσκειν. καὶ γὰρ ταφῆς καλῆς τε καὶ μεγαλοπρεποῦς τυγχάνει, καὶ ἐὰν πένης τις ὦν τελευτήσῃ, καὶ ἐπαίνου αὖ ἔτυχεν, καὶ ἐὰν φαῦλος ᾖ, ὑπ' ἀνδρῶν σοφῶν τε καὶ οὐκ εἰκῇ ἐπαινούντων, ἀλλὰ ἐκ πολλοῦ χρόνου λόγους παρεσκευασμένων, οἳ οὕτως καλῶς ἐπαινοῦσιν, ὥστε καὶ τὰ προσόντα καὶ τὰ μὴ περὶ ἐκάστου λέγοντες, κάλλιστά πως τοῖς ὀνόμασι ποικίλλοντες, γοητεύουσιν ἡμῶν τὰς ψυχάς, καὶ τὴν πόλιν ἐγκωμιάζοντες κατὰ πάντας τρόπους καὶ τοὺς τετελευτηκότας ἐν τῷ πολέμῳ καὶ τοὺς προγόνους ἡμῶν ἅπαντας τοὺς ἔμπροσθεν καὶ αὐτοὺς ἡμᾶς τοὺς ἔτι ζῶντας ἐπαινοῦντες, ὥστ' ἔγωγε, ὦ Μενέξενε, γενναίως πάνυ διατίθεται ἐπαινούμενος ὑπ' αὐτῶν, καὶ ἐκάστοτε ἐξέστηκα

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S: And it often happens that some foreigners are regularly present along with me as part of the audience, and suddenly I become more exalted in their eyes. And, indeed, these people seem to be affected in the same way, both in relation to myself, and to the city in general which they believe to be more wonderful than they previously thought it to be, because they are won over by the speaker. This feeling of exaltation remains with me for three days or more, so deeply does the stream of speech and sound from the speaker sink in through my

ears. Only with difficulty, in four or five days, do I remember myself and realise that I am here on earth. Until then I just imagine that I am dwelling on the Isles of the Blest, so accomplished are these rhetoricians of ours.

ἀκρωόμενος καὶ κηλούμενος, ἡγούμενος ἐν τῷ παραχρῆμα μείζων καὶ γενναιότερος καὶ καλλίων γεγονέναι. καὶ οἷα δὴ τὰ πολλὰ ἀεὶ μετ' ἐμοῦ ξένοι τινὲς ἔπονται καὶ συνακροῶνται πρὸς οὓς ἐγὼ σεμνότερος ἐν τῷ παραχρῆμα γίγνομαι· καὶ γὰρ ἐκεῖνοι ταῦτα ταῦτα δοκοῦσί μοι πάσχειν καὶ πρὸς ἐμὲ καὶ πρὸς τὴν ἄλλην πόλιν, θαυμασιωτέραν αὐτὴν ἡγεῖσθαι εἶναι ἢ πρότερον, ὑπὸ τοῦ λέγοντος ἀναπειθόμενοι. καὶ μοι αὕτη ἡ σεμνότης παραμένει ἡμέρας πλείω ἢ τρεῖς· οὕτως ἔναυλος ὁ λόγος τε καὶ ὁ φθόγγος παρὰ τοῦ λέγοντος ἐνδύεται εἰς τὰ ὦτα, ὥστε μόγις τετάρτη ἢ πέμπτη ἡμέρᾳ ἀναμιμνήσκομαι ἐμαυτοῦ καὶ αἰσθάνομαι οὐ γῆς εἶμι, τέως δὲ οἶμαι μόνον οὐκ ἐν μακάρων νήσοις οἰκεῖν· οὕτως ἡμῖν οἱ ῥήτορες δεξιοὶ εἰσιν. MEN. ἀεὶ σὺ προσπαίζεις, ὦ Σώκρατες, τοὺς ῥήτορας. νῦν μέντοι οἶμαι ἐγὼ τὸν αἰρεθέντα οὐ πάνυ εὐπορήσειν· ἐξ ὑπογύου γὰρ παντάπασιν ἡ αἵρεσις γέγονεν, ὥστε ἴσως ἀναγκασθήσεται ὁ λέγων ὥσπερ αὐτοσχεδιάζειν.

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MX: Socrates, you are always mocking the rhetoricians. However, on this occasion, I think that whoever is selected won't be well prepared since the selection has been left very late, and so the speaker will probably be compelled, more or less, to improvise their speech.

ΣΩ. πόθεν, ὦγαθέ; εἰσὶν ἐκάστοις τούτων λόγοι παρεσκευασμένοι, καὶ ἅμα οὐδὲ αὐτοσχεδιάζειν τὰ γε τοιαῦτα χαλεπὸν. εἰ μὲν γὰρ δέοι Ἀθηναίους ἐν Πελοποννησίῳ εὖ λέγειν ἢ Πελοποννησίους ἐν Ἀθηναίοις, ἀγαθοῦ ἂν ῥήτορος δέοι τοῦ πείσοντος καὶ εὐδοκιμήσοντος· ὅταν δέ τις ἐν τούτοις ἀγωνίζεται οὕσπερ καὶ ἐπαινεῖ, οὐδὲν μέγα δοκεῖν εὖ λέγειν. MEN. οὐκ οἶε, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. οὐ μέντοι μὰ Δία.

S: How could that be so, my good friend? Each of these fellows has speeches already prepared, and, what's more, it is not difficult to improvise such speeches either. Indeed, if someone had to speak well of

Athenians before an audience of Peloponnesians, or of Peloponnesians before Athenians, a good rhetorician would be required who could be persuasive and well respected. But when performing before the very people he is praising, it is no great achievement to seem to speak well.

MX: You think not, Socrates?

S: Indeed not, by Zeus.

MX: Do you think that you yourself could deliver the speech if required, and if the Council selected you?

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S: Well, Menexenus, it would be no surprise if I too were able to deliver the speech. I happen to have a teacher of rhetoric who is far from ordinary. In fact, she has produced many a good rhetorician, including one, Pericles, the son of Xanthippus, who surpasses all other Greeks.

MEN. ἢ οἷε οἴός τ' ἂν εἶναι αὐτὸς εἰπεῖν, εἰ δέοι καὶ ἔλοιτό σε ἡ βουλή; ΣΩ. καὶ ἐμοὶ μέν γε, ὧ Μενέξενε, οὐδὲν θαυμαστὸν οἶω τ' εἶναι εἰπεῖν, ὧ τυγχάνει διδάσκαλος οὕσα οὐ πάνυ φαύλη περὶ ῥητορικῆς, ἀλλ' ἤπερ καὶ ἄλλους πολλοὺς καὶ ἀγαθοὺς πεποιήκε ῥήτορας, ἓνα δὲ καὶ διαφέροντα τῶν Ἑλλήνων, Περικλέα τὸν Ξανθίππου. MEN. τίς αὕτη; ἡ δῆλον ὅτι Ἀσπασίαν λέγεις; ΣΩ. λέγω γάρ, καὶ Κόννον γε τὸν Μητροβίου· οὗτοι γάρ

MX: Who is she? Or are you obviously referring to Aspasia?

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S: Yes I am, and to Connus, the son of Metrobius. For these are my two teachers, he of music, she of rhetoric. It is hardly surprising then that a man, trained in this way, is an accomplished speaker. But even a person who had been less well educated than me, having been taught music by Lamprus or rhetoric by Antiphon of Rhamnous,¹ even he could be well respected when praising Athenians before an audience of Athenians.

μοι δύο εἰσὶν διδάσκαλοι, ὁ μὲν μουσικῆς, ἡ δὲ ῥητορικῆς. οὕτω μὲν οὖν τρεφόμενον ἄνδρα οὐδὲν θαυμαστὸν δεινὸν εἶναι λέγειν· ἀλλὰ καὶ ὅστις ἐμοῦ κάκιον ἐπαιδεύθη, μουσικὴν μὲν ὑπὸ Λάμπρου παιδευθείς,

ρήτορικὴν δὲ ὑπ' Ἀντιφῶντος τοῦ Ῥαμνουσίου, ὅμως κἂν οὗτος οἶός τ' εἴη Ἀθηναίους γε ἐν Ἀθηναίοις ἐπαινῶν εὐδοκιμεῖν. ΜΕΝ. καὶ τί ἂν ἔχοις εἰπεῖν, εἰ δέοι σε λέγειν; ΣΩ. αὐτὸς μὲν παρ' ἑμαυτοῦ ἴσως οὐδέν, Ἀσπασίας δὲ

ΜΧ: And what would you have to say if you were required to speak?

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S: Although I probably have nothing of my own to say, I listened yesterday to Aspasia rehearsing a funeral oration about these very people. She had heard what you just reported, that the Athenians are about to select a speaker. So she went through a speech for me as it should be delivered, partly improvised, partly prepared in advance by cobbling together various parts left over from when she, as I believe, composed the funeral oration that Pericles delivered.

καὶ χθὲς ἠκροώμην περαινούσης ἐπιτάφιον λόγον περὶ αὐτῶν τούτων. ἤκουσε γὰρ ἅπερ σὺ λέγεις, ὅτι μέλλοιεν Ἀθηναῖοι αἰρεῖσθαι τὸν ἐροῦντα· ἔπειτα τὰ μὲν ἐκ τοῦ παραχρῆμά μοι διήει, οἷα δέοι λέγειν, τὰ δὲ πρότερον ἐσκεμμένη, ὅτε μοι δοκεῖ συνετίθει τὸν ἐπιτάφιον λόγον ὃν Περικλῆς εἶπεν, περιλείμματ' ἅττα ἐξ ἐκείνου συγκολλῶσα. ΜΕΝ. ἦ καὶ μνημονεύσαις ἂν ἃ ἔλεγεν ἡ Ἀσπασία; ΣΩ. εἰ μὴ ἀδικῶ γε· ἐμάνθανόν γέ τοι παρ' αὐτῆς, καὶ

ΜΧ: Can you actually remember what Aspasia said?

S: Yes, unless I am mistaken. I learned the speech from her at any rate, and I was lucky to escape being beaten when my memory failed me.

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ΜΧ: So why don't you run through it?

ὀλίγου πληγὰς ἔλαβον ὅτ' ἐπελανθανόμην. ΜΕΝ. τί οὖν οὐ διῆλθες; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ὅπως μὴ μοι χαλεπανεῖ ἡ διδάσκαλος, ἂν ἐξενέγκω αὐτῆς τὸν λόγον. ΜΕΝ. μηδαμῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλ' εἰπέ, καὶ πάνυ μοι χαριῆ, εἴτε Ἀσπασίας βούλει λέγειν εἴτε ὅτουοῦν· ἀλλὰ μόνον εἰπέ. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἴσως μου καταγελάσῃ, ἂν σοι δόξω πρεσβύτης ὢν ἔτι παίζειν. ΜΕΝ.

οὐδαμῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλ' εἰπὲ παντὶ τρόπῳ. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μέντοι σοί γε δεῖ χαρίζεσθαι, ὥστε καὶ ὀλίγου,

S: In case my teacher gets angry with me for making her speech public.

MX: No fear of that, Socrates, but speak on and you will please me greatly whether you choose to recite Aspasia's speech or someone else's. Just speak.

S: But perhaps you will laugh at me if you think I am still playing games in my old age.

MX: Not at all, Socrates, just speak anyway.

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S: But, of course, you deserve to be gratified, and even if you were to call upon me to undress and dance, I would gratify you since we are alone. So listen, for she spoke, I believe, initially of the dead themselves in the following way.

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S: “By our actions, these men have received all that they themselves deserve, possessed of which they proceed on that fated procession, accompanied in community by the city, and in private by their families. But the law also ordains that one remaining honour be bestowed upon them in words, and that's what is now required. For, by a well-delivered speech, remembrance and honour are assured to those who perform noble deeds, from all who hear of them. What is needed then is a speech that will give sufficient praise to the dead, while gently exhorting the living by calling upon their offspring and brothers to imitate the excellence of such people, and by consoling their mothers and fathers or any of their remaining ancestors who are still alive.

εἴ με κελεύοις ἀποδύντα ὀρχήσασθαι, χαρισαίμην ἄν, ἐπειδὴ γε μόνω ἐσμέν. ἀλλ' ἄκουε. ἔλεγε γάρ, ὥς ἐγῶμαι, ἀρξαμένη λέγειν ἀπ' αὐτῶν τῶν τεθνεώτων οὕτως. ἔργῳ μὲν ἡμῖν οἶδε ἔχουσιν τὰ προσήκοντα σφίσιν αὐτοῖς, ὧν τυχόντες πορεύονται τὴν εἰμαρμένην πορείαν,

προπεμφθέντες κοινῇ μὲν ὑπὸ τῆς πόλεως, ἰδίᾳ δὲ ὑπὸ τῶν οἰκείων· λόγῳ δὲ δὴ τὸν λειπόμενον κόσμον ὃ τε νόμος προστάττει ἀποδοῦναι τοῖς ἀνδράσιν καὶ χρή. ἔργων γὰρ εὖ πραχθέντων λόγῳ καλῶς ῥηθέντι μνήμη καὶ κόσμος τοῖς πράξασι γίγνεται παρὰ τῶν ἀκουσάντων· δεῖ δὴ τοιούτου τινὸς λόγου ὅστις τοὺς μὲν τετελευτηκότας ἱκανῶς ἐπαινέσεται, τοῖς δὲ ζῶσιν εὐμενῶς παραινέσεται, ἐκγόνοις μὲν καὶ ἀδελφοῖς μιμεῖσθαι τὴν τῶνδε ἀρετὴν παρακελευόμενος, πατέρας δὲ καὶ μητέρας καὶ εἴ τινας τῶν ἄνωθεν ἔτι προγόνων λείπονται, τούτους δὲ

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S: “So what sort of speech might portray this for us? Where might we rightly begin our praise of such good men who, whilst living, gladdened their compatriots by their excellence, and, in death, purchased the salvation of the living? I believe we should praise these men in accord with nature and the manner in which they became good. They became good because of their birth from good parents. So we should first praise their noble origins, and then their upbringing and education. After that we shall display the catalogue of their deeds and show how noble these were, and how worthy of their lineage. Their ancestry was primarily responsible for their noble birth. Their descent was not from outsiders, nor did their lineage turn such descendants into mere settlers in this land, mere arrivals from elsewhere. They were, rather, sprung from the very land itself, inhabiting their true fatherland, living there, being reared not by a stepmother like other peoples, but by their own mother; this land in which they dwelt and under which they now lie in death in familiar regions of the land that bore them, nurtured them, and has now received them back again. But it is only right to begin by honouring the mother herself, for in this way it follows that we honour the noble birth of these men at the same time.

παραμυθούμενος. ΣΩ. τίς οὖν ἂν ἡμῖν τοιοῦτος λόγος φανείη; ἢ πόθεν ἂν ὀρθῶς ἀρξαίμεθα ἄνδρας ἀγαθοὺς ἐπαινοῦντες, οἱ ζῶντές τε τοὺς ἑαυτῶν ἡϋφραῖνον δι’ ἀρετὴν, καὶ τὴν τελευτὴν ἀντὶ τῆς τῶν ζώντων

σωτηρίας ἡλλάξαντο; δοκεῖ μοι χρῆναι κατὰ φύσιν, ὥσπερ ἀγαθοὶ ἐγένοντο, οὕτω καὶ ἐπαινεῖν αὐτούς. ἀγαθοὶ δὲ ἐγένοντο διὰ τὸ φῦναι ἐξ ἀγαθῶν. τὴν εὐγένειαν οὖν πρῶτον αὐτῶν ἐγκωμιάζωμεν, δεύτερον δὲ τροφήν τε καὶ παιδείαν· ἐπὶ δὲ τούτοις τὴν τῶν ἔργων πρᾶξιν ἐπιδείξωμεν, ὡς καλὴν καὶ ἀξίαν τούτων ἀπεφάνησαντο. τῆς δ' εὐγενείας πρῶτον ὑπῆρξε τοῖσδε ἡ τῶν προγόνων γένεσις οὐκ ἔπηλυσ οὔσα, οὐδὲ τοὺς ἐκγόνους τούτους ἀποφνηαμένη μετοικοῦντας ἐν τῇ χώρᾳ ἄλλοθεν σφῶν ἡκόντων, ἀλλ' αὐτόχθονας καὶ τῷ ὄντι ἐν πατρίδι οἰκοῦντας καὶ ζῶντας, καὶ τρεφομένους οὐχ ὑπὸ μητρυιᾶς ὡς οἱ ἄλλοι, ἀλλ' ὑπὸ

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S: “Our land is worthy of praise not just by ourselves but by all peoples for all sorts of reasons, but first and foremost because it happens to be beloved of the gods. Proof of our assertion lies in the disputation of the gods about this land, and the associated judgement.² And surely it is only right that all of us humans should praise the land that the gods praise? The second basis for deserved praise of our land would be that in an age in which the entire earth was productive and brought forth a vast variety of creatures, wild and tame, our land proved to be undefiled, producing no wild animals, but of all creatures it chose to give birth to the human being, who exceeds all others in understanding and who alone believes in justice and the gods. Strong evidence for this assertion lies in the fact that the land has given birth to the ancestors of these people, and to ours too. For anything that gives birth possesses the nutriment needed by its offspring, and by this fact we can see whether a woman is the true birth mother or just a foster mother who lacks the fount of nutriment for the offspring. And our land, our mother, provides evidence enough that she brought forth us humans, for at the time she alone was first to bear human nutriment, food consisting of wheat and barley by which the human race is best and most excellently nourished, proving that she really did bring forth this living being. And it is best to accept evidence of this sort as applicable more to the land than to woman, for in conceiving

and giving birth, earth does not imitate woman; no, woman imitates earth. But she did not begrudge this food; rather, she also apportioned it to others. After this she brought forth the olive for her children to help them in their travails. And having nurtured and reared them to adulthood, she brought in gods as their rulers and teachers, whose names we already know, so we should leave these aside for now. The gods equipped us for life by educating us first in skills for use in our daily lives, and also for the defence of our country by teaching us the acquisition and use of arms.

μητρὸς τῆς χώρας ἐν ἣ ὥκουν, καὶ νῦν κεῖσθαι τελευτήσαντας ἐν οἰκείοις τόποις τῆς τεκούσης καὶ θρεψάσης καὶ ὑποδεξαμένης. δικαιοτάτον δὴ κοσμήσαι πρῶτον τὴν μητέρα αὐτήν· οὕτω γὰρ συμβαίνει ἅμα καὶ ἡ τῶνδε εὐγένεια κοσμουμένη. ἔστι δὲ ἀξία ἡ χώρα καὶ ὑπὸ πάντων ἀνθρώπων ἐπαινεῖσθαι, οὐ μόνον ὑφ' ἡμῶν, πολλαχῇ μὲν καὶ ἄλλῃ, πρῶτον δὲ καὶ μέγιστον ὅτι τυγχάνει οὕσα θεοφιλῆς. μαρτυρεῖ δὲ ἡμῶν τῷ λόγῳ ἡ τῶν ἀμφισβητησάντων περὶ αὐτῆς θεῶν ἔρις τε καὶ κρίσις· ἦν δὴ θεοὶ ἐπήνεσαν, πῶς οὐχ ὑπ' ἀνθρώπων γε συμπάντων δικαία ἐπαινεῖσθαι; δεύτερος δὲ ἔπαινος δικαίως ἂν αὐτῆς εἴη, ὅτι ἐν ἐκείνῳ τῷ χρόνῳ, ἐν ᾧ ἡ πᾶσα γῆ ἀνεδίδου καὶ ἔφυσε ζῶα παντοδαπά, θηρία τε καὶ βοτάνη, ἐν τούτῳ ἡ ἡμετέρα θηρίων μὲν ἀγρίων ἄγονος καὶ καθαρὰ ἐφάνη, ἐξελέξατο δὲ τῶν ζώων καὶ ἐγέννησεν ἄνθρωπον, ὃ συνέσει τε ὑπερέχει τῶν ἄλλων καὶ δίκην καὶ θεοὺς μόνον νομίζει. μέγα δὲ τεκμήριον τούτῳ τῷ λόγῳ, ὅτι ἦδε ἔτεκεν ἡ γῆ τοὺς τῶνδ' ἐκείνους καὶ ἡμετέρους προγόνους. πᾶν γὰρ τὸ τεκὸν τροφήν ἔχει ἐπιτηδείαν ᾧ ἂν τέκη, ᾧ καὶ γυνὴ δῆλη τεκοῦσά τε ἀληθῶς καὶ μή, ἀλλ' ὑποβαλλομένη, ἐὰν μὴ ἔχῃ πηγὰς τροφῆς τῷ γεννωμένῳ. ΣΩ. ὃ δὴ καὶ ἡ ἡμετέρα γῆ τε καὶ μήτηρ ἱκανὸν τεκμήριον παρέχεται ὥς ἀνθρώπους γεννησαμένη μόνη γὰρ ἐν τῷ τότε καὶ πρώτη τροφήν ἀνθρωπείαν ἤνεγκεν τὸν τῶν πυρῶν καὶ κριθῶν καρπὸν, ᾧ κάλλιστα καὶ ἄριστα τρέφεται τὸ ἀνθρώπειον γένος, ὥς τῷ ὄντι τοῦτο τὸ ζῶον αὐτὴ γεννησαμένη. μᾶλλον δὲ ὑπὲρ γῆς ἢ γυναικὸς προσήκει δέχεσθαι τοιαῦτα τεκμήρια· οὐ γὰρ γῆ γυναῖκα μεμίμηται κυήσει καὶ γεννήσει, ἀλλὰ γυνὴ γῆν. τούτου δὲ τοῦ καρποῦ οὐκ ἐφθόνησεν, ἀλλ' ἔνειμεν καὶ

τοῖς ἄλλοις· μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο ἐλαίου γένεσιν, πόνων ἀρωγὴν, ἀνῆκεν τοῖς ἐκγόνοις· θρεψαμένη δὲ καὶ αὐξήσασα πρὸς ἥβην ἄρχοντας καὶ διδασκάλους αὐτῶν θεοὺς ἐπηγάγετο· ὧν τὰ μὲν ὀνόματα πρέπει ἐν τῷ τοιῷδε ἔαν—ἴσμεν γάρ—οἱ τὸν βίον ἡμῶν κατεσκεύασαν πρὸς τε τὴν καθ’ ἡμέραν δίαιταν, τέχνας πρῶτους παιδευσάμενοι, καὶ πρὸς τὴν ὑπὲρ τῆς χώρας φυλακὴν ὅπλων κτῆσίν τε καὶ χρῆσιν διδασκόμενοι· γεννηθέντες δὲ καὶ παιδευθέντες οὕτως οἱ τῶνδε πρόγονοι ὥκουν πολιτείαν κατασκευασάμενοι, ἥς ὀρθῶς ἔχει διὰ βραχέων

238c

S: “Having been born and educated in this way, the ancestors of these people lived under a civic arrangement, which they framed for themselves and merits a brief mention now. For a civic arrangement is a nurturer of humanity, a good one of good people, a bad one of bad people. So it is necessary to show that our ancestors were nurtured under a good civic arrangement because of which they were good people, as are the present generation, including the fallen who lie here before us. For this civic arrangement was then, and is now, the rule of the best, under which we live as citizens today, and for the most part always have done since that past era. One person calls this democracy, another names it as they please, but it is, in truth, aristocracy with popular approval. For although we always have kings, these are sometimes hereditary and sometimes selected. Yet, for the most part, the people hold power in the city, and they devolve power and positions of authority to those deemed best at any time, and no one is excluded from power by weakness or poverty or the obscurity of their ancestry, nor are they preferred for the opposite reasons as happens in other cities. There is but one criterion, that whoever is regarded as wise and good exercises power and authority.

ἐπιμνησθῆναι· πολιτεία γὰρ τροφή ἀνθρώπων ἐστίν, καλὴ μὲν ἀγαθῶν, ἡ δὲ ἐναντία κακῶν· ὥς οὖν ἐν καλῇ πολιτείᾳ ἐτρέφθησαν οἱ πρόσθεν ἡμῶν, ἀναγκαῖον δηλῶσαι, δι’ ἣν δὴ κάκεῖνοι ἀγαθοὶ καὶ οἱ νῦν εἰσιν, ὧν οἶδε τυγχάνουσιν ὄντες οἱ τετελευτηκότες· ἡ γὰρ αὕτη πολιτεία καὶ τότε ἦν καὶ νῦν, ἀριστοκρατία, ἐν ἣ νῦν τε πολιτευόμεθα καὶ τὸν αἰ

χρόνον ἐξ ἐκείνου ὡς τὰ πολλά. καλεῖ δὲ ὁ μὲν αὐτὴν δημοκρατίαν, ὁ δὲ ἄλλο, ᾧ ἂν χαίρῃ, ἔστι δὲ τῇ ἀληθείᾳ μετ' εὐδοξίας πλήθους ἀριστοκρατία. βασιλῆς μὲν γὰρ αἰεὶ ἡμῖν εἰσιν· οὗτοι δὲ τοτὲ μὲν ἐκ γένους, τοτὲ δὲ αἵρετοί· ἐγκρατὲς δὲ τῆς πόλεως τὰ πολλά τὸ πλῆθος, τὰς δὲ ἀρχὰς δίδωσι καὶ κράτος τοῖς αἰεὶ δόξασιν ἀρίστοις εἶναι, καὶ οὔτε ἀσθενεῖα οὔτε πενία οὔτ' ἀγνωσία πατέρων ἀπελήλαται οὐδεὶς οὐδὲ τοῖς ἐναντίοις τετίμηται, ὥσπερ ἐν ἄλλαις πόλεσιν, ἀλλὰ εἰς ὅρος, ὁ δόξας σοφὸς ἢ ἀγαθὸς εἶναι κρατεῖ καὶ ἄρχει.

238e

S: “Equality of birth is responsible for our civic arrangement. Other cities are constituted from people of all sorts who are not equal, so that their civic arrangements, which are tyrannies and oligarchies, are also unequal. Their inhabitants regard one another in some cases as slaves, in other cases as masters, while we and our kindred, all brothers born of the same mother, do not expect to be slaves or masters of one another. Our natural equality of birth compels us to seek equality under the law, lawfully, and to yield to one another in nothing except a reputation for excellence and wisdom.

αἰτία δὲ ἡμῖν τῆς πολιτείας ταύτης ἡ ἐξ ἴσου γένεσις. ΣΩ. αἱ μὲν γὰρ ἄλλαι πόλεις ἐκ παντοδαπῶν κατεσκευασμέναι ἀνθρώπων εἰσὶ καὶ ἀνωμάτων, ὥστε αὐτῶν ἀνώμαλοι καὶ αἱ πολιτεῖαι, τυραννίδες τε καὶ ὀλιγαρχίαι· οἰκοῦσιν οὖν ἔνιοι μὲν δούλους, οἱ δὲ δεσπότας ἀλλήλους νομίζοντες· ἡμεῖς δὲ καὶ οἱ ἡμέτεροι,

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S: “As a consequence, the fathers of these people, our fathers too, and the people themselves, all of noble birth, having been reared in total freedom have displayed many noble deeds for all to see, both in private and in public, in the belief that they should fight for freedom with Greeks on behalf of Greeks, and with non-Greeks on behalf of all Greeks. The story of how they defended their own country when Eumolpus and the Amazons and others before that waged war against it, and how they defended the Argives against the Cadmeans, and the Heraclids against the Argives,³ deserves more time to recount. But

their excellence has already been well hymned in verse by the poets and proclaimed to all. So, if we were to attempt to do justice to these same exploits in plain prose, we would probably appear second-rate. That's why I think we should leave them aside, since they have received the praise they deserve. But there are other deeds which still lie forgotten, for which no poet has yet received a reputation worthy of these worthy themes. These, I believe, should be mentioned, praising them and drawing out subjects for others to set down in odes and poetry in general, in a manner worthy of those who performed the deeds.

μῖα^s μητρὸς πάντες ἀδελφοὶ φύντες, οὐκ ἀξιοῦμεν δοῦλοι οὐδὲ δεσπόται ἀλλήλων εἶναι, ἀλλ' ἡ ἰσογονία ἡμᾶς ἡ κατὰ φύσιν ἰσονομίαν ἀναγκάζει ζητεῖν κατὰ νόμον, καὶ μηδενὶ ἄλλω ὑπέικειν ἀλλήλοις ἢ ἀρετῆς δόξῃ καὶ φρονήσεως. ὅθεν δὴ ἐν πάσῃ ἐλευθερίᾳ τεθραμμένοι οἱ τῶνδ' γε πατέρες καὶ οἱ ἡμέτεροι καὶ αὐτοὶ οὗτοι, καὶ καλῶς φύντες, πολλὰ δὴ καὶ καλὰ ἔργα ἀπεφάναντο εἰς πάντας ἀνθρώπους καὶ ἰδίᾳ καὶ δημοσίᾳ, οἰόμενοι δεῖν ὑπὲρ τῆς ἐλευθερίας καὶ Ἑλλήσιν ὑπὲρ Ἑλλήνων μάχεσθαι καὶ βαρβάροις ὑπὲρ ἀπάντων τῶν Ἑλλήνων. Εὐμόλπου μὲν οὖν καὶ Ἀμαζόνων ἐπιστρατευσάντων ἐπὶ τὴν χώραν καὶ τῶν ἔτι προτέρων ὡς ἡμύναντο, καὶ ὡς ἤμυναν Ἀργείοις πρὸς Καδμείους καὶ Ἡρακλείδαις πρὸς Ἀργείους, ὃ τε χρόνος βραχὺς ἀξίως διηγῆσασθαι, ποιηταὶ τε αὐτῶν ἤδη καλῶς τὴν ἀρετὴν ἐν μουσικῇ ὑμνήσαντες εἰς πάντας μεμνηύκασιν· ἔαν οὖν ἡμεῖς ἐπιχειρῶμεν τὰ αὐτὰ λόγῳ ψιλῶ κοσμεῖν, τάχ' ἂν δεύτεροι φαινοίμεθα. ταῦτα μὲν οὖν διὰ ταῦτα δοκεῖ μοι ἔαν, ἐπειδὴ καὶ ἔχει τὴν ἀξίαν· ὣν δὲ οὔτε ποιητὴς πω δόξαν ἀξίαν ἐπ' ἀξίοις λαβὼν ἔχει ἔτι τέ ἐστιν ἐν ἀμνηστία, τούτων πέρι μοι δοκεῖ χρῆναι ἐπιμνησθῆναι ἐπαινοῦντά τε καὶ προμνῶμενον ἄλλοις ἐς ὧδ' αὖτε καὶ τὴν ἄλλην ποίησιν αὐτὰ θεῖναι πρεπόντως τῶν πραξάντων. ἔστιν δὲ τούτων ὣν λέγω

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S: “The first of these occurred when the Persians were in control of Asia and were in the process of enslaving Europe. The children of this land – our parents – withstood them, and it is right and necessary to

mention them first and praise their excellence. Now, if anyone is to praise this well, they need to look at it having gone back in time, mentally, to that era when all Asia was already enslaved by the third king. The first of these kings was Cyrus who liberated the Persians, his fellow countrymen, by his own determination. At the same time, he also enslaved the despotic Medes and ruled over the rest of Asia as far as Egypt. His son ruled Egypt, and Libya too, as far as he was able to advance. The third king, Darius, with his land forces, set their boundary as far away as Scythia, and dominated the seas and the islands with his navy so that no one even thought of opposing him. All peoples were mentally enslaved because the Persian Empire had enslaved so many great military nations.

πρῶτα Πέρσας ἡγουμένους τῆς Ἀσίας καὶ δουλουμένους τὴν Εὐρώπην ἔσχον οἱ τῆσδε τῆς χώρας ἔκγονοι, γονῆς δὲ ἡμέτεροι, ὧν καὶ δίκαιον καὶ χρὴ πρῶτον μεμνημένους ἐπαινέσαι αὐτῶν τὴν ἀρετὴν. δεῖ δὴ αὐτὴν ἰδεῖν, εἰ μέλλει τις καλῶς ἐπαινεῖν, ἐν ἐκείνῳ τῷ χρόνῳ γενόμενον λόγῳ, ὅτε πᾶσα μὲν ἡ Ἀσία ἐδούλευε τρίτῳ ἤδη βασιλεῖ, ὧν ὁ μὲν πρῶτος Κῦρος ἐλευθερώσας Πέρσας τοὺς αὐτοῦ πολίτας τῷ αὐτοῦ φρονήματι ἅμα καὶ τοὺς δεσπότης Μήδους ἐδουλώσατο καὶ τῆς ἄλλης Ἀσίας μέχρι Αἰγύπτου ἤρξεν, ΣΩ. ὁ δὲ ὑὸς Αἰγύπτου τε καὶ Λιβύης ὅσον οἶόν τ' ἦν ἐπιβαίνειν, τρίτος δὲ Δαρεῖος πεζῇ μὲν μέχρι Σκυθῶν τὴν ἀρχὴν ὠρίσατο, ναυσὶ δὲ τῆς τε

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S: “Darius made an accusation against ourselves and the Eritreans. On the pretext that we had plotted against Sardis, he sent 500,000 men in transport ships and battleships along with 300 ships of war. Datis was in command, and Darius told him to return, bringing the Eritreans and Athenians in captivity if he wished to keep his own head. He sailed to Eritrea against men who were among the most famous of the Greeks in warfare at the time, and whose numbers were not small. These he overpowered in three days, and he then conducted a search of their entire territory so that no one would escape him. This is how he did it. Having arrived at the borders of Eretria, his soldiers positioned

themselves at intervals from sea to sea. They joined hands and went through the entire region so that they would be able to say to their king that no one could have escaped them. With the same intention, they set sail from Eritrea to Marathon, assuming it would be easy for them to subject the Athenians to the same fate as the Eritreans and place them under the yoke of captivity. Although they had implemented their plans, and their attempted enslavement was underway, no fellow Greeks came to the aid of the Eritreans and the Athenians except for the Spartans, who arrived the day after the battle. All the others were terrified, and they kept quiet, prizing their temporary safety. By placing yourself in their situation, you may realise the sort of men these were in terms of excellence, who took on the might of the non-Greeks at Marathon, chastened the pride of all Asia, and were the very first people to erect a victory trophy over the non-Greeks, thus becoming leaders who taught everyone else that the might of the Persians was not invincible, but that numbers and wealth always yield to excellence. So, I declare that these men were not only the fathers of our physical bodies, but also of freedom for ourselves and for all those who dwell on this continent. Indeed, once they beheld this achievement, the Greeks, as pupils of the soldiers of Marathon, were emboldened to run the risks involved in the subsequent battles for the sake of our security.

θαλάττης ἐκράτει καὶ τῶν νήσων, ὥστε μὴδὲ ἀξιοῦν ἀντίπαλον αὐτῷ μηδὲνα εἶναι· αἱ δὲ γινῶμαι δεδουλωμένοι ἀπάντων ἀνθρώπων ἦσαν· οὕτω πολλὰ καὶ μεγάλα καὶ μάχιμα γένη καταδεδουλωμένα ἦν ἡ Περσῶν ἀρχή· αἰτιασάμενος δὲ Δαρεῖος ἡμᾶς τε καὶ Ἑρετριᾶς, Σάρδεσιν ἐπιβουλευσά προφασιζόμενος, πέμψας μυριάδας μὲν πεντήκοντα ἔν τε πλοίοις καὶ ναυσίν, ναῦς δὲ τριακοσίας, Δᾶτιν δὲ ἄρχοντα, εἶπεν ἡκεῖν ἄγοντα Ἑρετριᾶς καὶ Ἀθηναίους, εἰ βούλοιο τὴν ἑαυτοῦ κεφαλὴν ἔχειν· ὁ δὲ πλεύσας εἰς Ἑρέτριαν ἐπ' ἄνδρας οἱ τῶν τότε Ἑλλήνων ἐν τοῖς εὐδοκιμώτατοι ἦσαν τὰ πρὸς τὸν πόλεμον καὶ οὐκ ὀλίγοι, τούτους ἐχειρώσατο μὲν ἐν τρισὶν ἡμέραις, διηρευνήσατο δὲ αὐτῶν πᾶσαν τὴν χώραν, ἵνα μηδεὶς ἀποφύγοι, τοιούτῳ τρόπῳ· ἐπὶ τὰ ὄρια ἐλθόντες τῆς

Ἑρετρικῆς οἱ στρατιῶται αὐτοῦ, ἐκ θαλάττης εἰς θάλατταν διαστάντες, συνάψαντες τὰς χεῖρας διήλθον ἅπασαν τὴν χώραν, ἵν' ἔχοιεν τῷ βασιλεῖ εἰπεῖν ὅτι οὐδείς σφᾶς ἀποπεφευγώς εἴη. τῇ δ' αὐτῇ διανοίᾳ κατηγάγοντο ἐξ Ἑρετρίας εἰς Μαραθῶνα, ὡς ἔτοιμόν σφισιν ὄν καὶ Ἀθηναίους ἐν τῇ αὐτῇ ταύτῃ ἀνάγκῃ ζεύξαντας Ἑρετριεῦσιν ἄγειν. τούτων δὲ τῶν μὲν πραχθέντων, τῶν δ' ἐπιχειρουμένων οὗτ' Ἑρετριεῦσιν ἐβοήθησεν Ἑλλήνων οὐδείς οὔτε Ἀθηναίοις πλὴν Λακεδαιμονίων—οὔτοι δὲ τῇ ὑστεραίᾳ τῆς μάχης ἀφίκοντο—οἱ δ' ἄλλοι πάντες ἐκπεπληγμένοι, ἀγαπῶντες τὴν ἐν τῷ παρόντι σωτηρίαν, ἡσυχίαν ἦγον. ἐν τούτῳ δὴ ἂν τις γενόμενος γνοίῃ οἷοι ἄρα ἐτύγχανον ὄντες τὴν ἀρετὴν οἱ Μαραθῶνι δεξάμενοι τὴν τῶν βαρβάρων δύναμιν καὶ κολασάμενοι τὴν ὑπερηφανίαν ὅλης τῆς Ἀσίας καὶ πρῶτοι στήσαντες τρόπαια τῶν βαρβάρων, ἡγεμόνες καὶ διδάσκαλοι τοῖς ἄλλοις γενόμενοι ὅτι οὐκ ἄμαχος εἴη ἡ Περσῶν δύναμις, ἀλλὰ πᾶν πλῆθος καὶ πᾶς πλοῦτος ἀρετῇ ὑπείκει. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν ἐκείνους τοὺς ἄνδρας φημὶ οὐ μόνον τῶν σωμάτων τῶν ἡμετέρων πατέρας εἶναι, ἀλλὰ καὶ τῆς ἐλευθερίας τῆς τε ἡμετέρας καὶ συμπάντων τῶν ἐν τῇδε τῇ ἡπείρῳ· εἰς ἐκεῖνο γὰρ τὸ ἔργον ἀποβλέψαντες καὶ τὰς ὑστέρας μάχας ἐτόλμησαν διακινδυνεύειν οἱ Ἕλληνες ὑπὲρ τῆς σωτηρίας, μαθηταὶ τῶν Μαραθῶνι γενόμενοι. ΣΩ. τὰ μὲν οὖν ἀριστεῖα τῷ λόγῳ ἐκεῖνοις ἀναθετόν,

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S: “Now, although we must in our speech grant primacy to these people, second place should go to those who were victorious in the naval battles around Salamis and at Artemisium.⁴ There is, of course, much to recount about these men too, and the sorts of onslaughts they endured by land and by sea, and how they defended themselves against these. But I shall also mention what I regard as their supreme achievement, that they completed the next task after the accomplishments at Marathon. For the victors at Marathon only demonstrated to their fellow Greeks that a few of them could defeat many non-Greeks in a land battle. But in a naval battle, the doubt remained, and the Persians were reputed to be invincible by sea

because of their numbers, their wealth, their skill and their strength. So of all the achievements of the men who fought the naval battles at the time, what deserves our praise is the fact that they did away with this remaining fear among the Greeks by stopping them from being afraid of large numbers of ships and men. It follows, then, that the rest of the Greeks were educated by the soldiers who fought at Marathon and the sailors who fought at Salamis. They learned the discipline of not fearing the non-Greeks either by land, as taught by one group, or by sea, as taught by the other. But I maintain that, both in rank and in excellence, the action at Plateia for the security of Greece came third, and here at last was a joint endeavour of the Spartans and the Athenians. All these men ward off the greatest and most grievous danger, and we are praising them now for this display of excellence, as will our successors in time to come.

τὰ δὲ δευτερεῖα τοῖς περὶ Σαλαμῖνα καὶ ἐπ' Ἀρτεμισίῳ ναυμαχήσασι καὶ νικήσασι. καὶ γὰρ τούτων τῶν ἀνδρῶν πολλὰ μὲν ἂν τις ἔχοι διελθεῖν, καὶ οἷα ἐπιόντα ὑπέμειναν κατὰ τε γῆν καὶ κατὰ θάλατταν, καὶ ὡς ἡμύναντο ταῦτα· ὃ δέ μοι δοκεῖ καὶ ἐκείνων κάλλιστον εἶναι, τούτου μνησθήσομαι, ὅτι τὸ ἐξῆς ἔργον τοῖς Μαραθῶνι διεπράξαντο. οἱ μὲν γὰρ Μαραθῶνι τοσοῦτον μόνον ἐπέδειξαν τοῖς Ἕλλησιν, ὅτι κατὰ γῆν οἶόν τε ἀμύνασθαι τοὺς βαρβάρους ὀλίγοις πολλούς, ναυσὶ δὲ ἔτι ἦν ἄδηλον καὶ δόξαν εἶχον Πέρσαι ἄμαχοι εἶναι κατὰ θάλατταν καὶ πλήθει καὶ πλούτῳ καὶ τέχνῃ καὶ ῥώμῃ· τοῦτο δὲ ἄξιον ἐπαινεῖν τῶν ἀνδρῶν τῶν τότε ναυμαχησάντων, ὅτι τὸν ἐχόμενον φόβον διέλυσαν τῶν Ἑλλήνων καὶ ἔπαυσαν φοβουμένους πλῆθος νεῶν τε καὶ ἀνδρῶν. ὑπ' ἀμφοτέρων δὲ συμβαίνει, τῶν τε Μαραθῶνι μαχεσαμένων καὶ τῶν ἐν Σαλαμῖνι ναυμαχησάντων, παιδευθῆναι τοὺς ἄλλους Ἕλληνας, ὑπὸ μὲν τῶν κατὰ γῆν, ὑπὸ δὲ τῶν κατὰ θάλατταν μαθόντας καὶ ἐθισθέντας μὴ φοβεῖσθαι τοὺς βαρβάρους. τρίτον δὲ λέγω τὸ ἐν Πλαταιαῖς ἔργον καὶ ἀριθμῷ καὶ ἀρετῇ γενέσθαι τῆς Ἑλληνικῆς σωτηρίας, κοινὸν ἤδη τοῦτο Λακεδαιμονίων τε καὶ Ἀθηναίων. τὸ μὲν οὖν μέγιστον καὶ χαλεπώτατον οὗτοι πάντες ἡμύναντο, καὶ διὰ ταύτην τὴν ἀρετὴν νῦν τε ὑφ' ἡμῶν ἐγκωμιάζονται καὶ εἰς τὸν ἔπειτα

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S: “But afterwards, many Greek cities were still aligned with the non-Greeks, and it was reported that the King himself was planning to make another attempt against the Greeks. It is only right, then, for us to mention those who brought the endeavours of their predecessors for our security to a conclusion by clearing out all the non-Greeks and driving them from our waters. These were the sailors who fought at Eurymedon and the soldiers who waged war against Cyprus, and those who sailed to Egypt and lots of other places. These are people we should mention with gratitude because they forced the King, out of fear, to pay attention to his own security rather than plotting the annihilation of the Greeks.

χρόνον ὑπὸ τῶν ὕστερον· μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο πολλαὶ μὲν πόλεις τῶν Ἑλλήνων ἔτι ἦσαν μετὰ τοῦ βαρβάρου, αὐτὸς δὲ ἡγγέλλετο βασιλεὺς διανοεῖσθαι ὡς ἐπιχειρήσων πάλιν ἐπὶ τοὺς Ἕλληνας, δίκαιον δὴ καὶ τούτων ἡμᾶς ἐπιμνησθῆναι, οἳ τοῖς τῶν προτέρων ἔργοις τέλος τῆς σωτηρίας ἐπέθεσαν ἀνακαθηράμενοι καὶ ἐξελάσαντες πᾶν τὸ βάρβαρον ἐκ τῆς θαλάττης. ἦσαν δὲ οὗτοι οἳ τε ἐπ’ Εὐρυμέδοντι ναυμαχῆσαντες καὶ οἳ εἰς Κύπρον στρατεύσαντες καὶ οἳ εἰς Αἴγυπτον πλεύσαντες καὶ ἄλλοσε πολλαχόσε, ὧν χρὴ μεμνησθαι καὶ χάριν αὐτοῖς εἰδέναι, ὅτι βασιλέα ἐποίησαν δέισαντα τῇ ἑαυτοῦ σωτηρίᾳ τὸν νοῦν προσέχειν, ἀλλὰ μὴ τῇ τῶν Ἑλλήνων ἐπιβουλεύειν φθορᾷ. ΣΩ. καὶ οὗτος μὲν δὴ πάσῃ τῇ πόλει διηντλήθη ὁ πόλεμος ὑπὲρ

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S: “Now, this war against the non-Greeks was endured to the very end by our entire city, on our own behalf, and on behalf of all Greek speaking peoples. But when peace had come and our city had won respect, we suffered the fate that tends to befall those who are successful. We were the victims first of a general rivalry, and then of jealousy, which drew this city, against its will, into a war against our fellow Greeks. After this, once the war was underway, whilst fighting for the freedom of the Boeotians, we met with the Spartans at Tanagra, and although the battle was indecisive, the subsequent action did

decide the matter, for the Spartans withdrew and departed, deserting the very people they were assisting, while on the third day our army won a victory at Oenophyta and justly brought back the people who had been unjustly expelled. These warriors, then, were the first who, after the Persian war, assisted their fellow Greeks against fellow Greeks in the cause of freedom, proved themselves to be good men who liberated those whom they helped, and having been honoured by the city, were the first to be buried here in this tomb.

ἐαυτῶν τε καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὁμοφώνων πρὸς τοὺς βαρβάρους· εἰρήνης δὲ γενομένης καὶ τῆς πόλεως τιμωμένης ἦλθεν ἐπ’ αὐτήν, ὃ δὴ φιλεῖ ἐκ τῶν ἀνθρώπων τοῖς εὖ πράττουσι προσπίπτειν, πρῶτον μὲν ζήλος, ἀπὸ ζήλου δὲ φθόνος· ὃ καὶ τήνδε τὴν πόλιν ἄκουσαν ἐν πολέμῳ τοῖς Ἑλλήσι κατέστησεν. μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο γενομένου πολέμου, συνέβαλον μὲν ἐν Τανάγρα ὑπὲρ τῆς Βοιωτῶν ἐλευθερίας Λακεδαιμονίοις μαχόμενοι, ἀμφισβητήσιμου δὲ τῆς μάχης γενομένης, διέκρινε τὸ ὕστερον ἔργον· οἱ μὲν γὰρ ὥχοντο ἀπόντες, καταλιπόντες Βοιωτοὺς οἷς ἐβοήθουν, οἱ δ’ ἡμέτεροι τρίτῃ ἡμέρᾳ ἐν Οἰνοφύτοις νικήσαντες τοὺς ἀδίκως φεύγοντας δικαίως κατήγαγον. οὗτοι δὲ πρῶτοι μετὰ τὸν Περσικὸν πόλεμον, Ἑλλήσιν ἤδη ὑπὲρ τῆς ἐλευθερίας βοηθοῦντες πρὸς Ἑλληνας, ἄνδρες ἀγαθοὶ

242c

S: “But subsequent to these events there was an extensive war,⁵ and all the Greeks marched against us and ravaged our territory, treating this city as it ill deserved. Yet when our troops had defeated them at sea and captured the Spartan leaders at Sphacteria, we could have slaughtered them, but we let them go, sent them back, and made peace, taking the view that we should pursue a war against our fellow Greeks only to the point of victory, and should not do violence to the common fellowship of the Greek peoples because of resentment particular to our own city. However, against non-Greeks, war should, we thought, be pursued to the point of destruction. These men deserve our praise, men who fought in the war and who now lie here, because they proved that if anyone argues that in the previous war – the one against the non-

Greeks – any other peoples were superior to the Athenians, that argument is entirely untrue. These men here have proved this by prevailing militarily in the strife amongst the Greeks by getting the better of the leaders of the other Greeks, and by defeating, on their own, the very people alongside whom they had once defeated the non-Greeks.

γενόμενοι καὶ ἐλευθερώσαντες οἷς ἐβοήθουν, ἐν τῷδε τῷ μνήματι τιμηθέντες ὑπὸ τῆς πόλεως πρῶτοι ἐτέθησαν. μετὰ δὲ ταῦτα πολλοῦ πολέμου γενομένου, καὶ πάντων τῶν Ἑλλήνων ἐπιστρατευσάντων καὶ τεμόντων τὴν χώραν καὶ ἀναξίαν χάριν ἐκτινόντων τῇ πόλει, νικήσαντες αὐτοὺς ναυμαχίᾳ οἱ ἡμέτεροι καὶ λαβόντες αὐτῶν τοὺς ἡγεμόνας Λακεδαιμονίους ἐν τῇ Σφαγίᾳ, ἐξὸν αὐτοῖς διαφθεῖραι ἐφείσαντο καὶ ἀπέδοσαν καὶ εἰρήνην ἐποιήσαντο, ἡγούμενοι πρὸς μὲν τὸ ὁμόφυλον μέχρι νίκης δεῖν πολεμεῖν, καὶ μὴ δι' ὀργὴν ἰδίαν πόλεως τὸ κοινὸν τῶν Ἑλλήνων διολλύναι, πρὸς δὲ τοὺς βαρβάρους μέχρι διαφθορᾶς. τούτους δὴ ἄξιον ἐπαινεῖσαι τοὺς ἄνδρας, οἱ τοῦτον τὸν πόλεμον πολεμήσαντες ἐνθάδε κεῖνται, ὅτι ἐπέδειξαν, εἴ τις ἄρα ἡμφεσβήτει ὡς ἐν τῷ προτέρῳ πολέμῳ τῷ πρὸς τοὺς βαρβάρους ἄλλοι τινὲς εἶεν ἀμείνους Ἀθηναίων, ὅτι οὐκ ἀληθῆ ἀμφισβητοῖεν οὗτοι

242e

S: “After the peace, a third war broke out,⁶ terrible and unexpected, in which many good men died, men who lie here. Many fell during the Sicilian campaign whilst fighting for the freedom of the Leontinians. Faithful to their oaths, they sailed to those regions, but because of the length of the journey and because our city was in difficulty and unable to support them, they met with misfortune and abandoned the campaign. But their enemies who fought against them had more praise for the sound-mindedness and excellence of these men than other people have for their own friends. Many others fell in the naval battles at the Hellespont, where they captured the entire enemy fleet in a single day and won numerous other victories.

γὰρ ἐνταῦθα ἔδειξαν, στασιασάσης τῆς Ἑλλάδος περιγενόμενοι τῷ πολέμῳ, τοὺς προεστῶτας τῶν ἄλλων Ἑλλήνων χειρωσάμενοι, μεθ' ὧν τότε τοὺς βαρβάρους ἐνίκων κοινῇ, τούτους νικῶντες ἰδίᾳ. ΣΩ. τρίτος δὲ πόλεμος μετὰ ταύτην τὴν εἰρήνην ἀνέλπιστός τε καὶ δεινὸς ἐγένετο, ἐν ᾧ πολλοὶ καὶ ἀγαθοὶ τελευτήσαντες ἐνθάδε κεῖνται, πολλοὶ μὲν ἄμφι Σικελίαν

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S: “I said that this war was terrible and unexpected. What I meant was that the other Greek cities became so determined to defeat us that they dared to make representations to the hated king, whom they had expelled during their alliance with ourselves. They asked him, on their own account, to come back again, non-Greeks leagued against Greeks, thus gathering the united forces of the Greeks and non-Greeks against our city. Here it was that the strength and excellence of our city shone forth. For they believed that we were already worn down by war, and although our navy was under threat in Mytilene, we sent sixty ships to the rescue. Our citizens manned these themselves and proved themselves beyond dispute to be the very best of men by defeating their enemies and liberating their fellows. But they met with undeserved misfortune when their bodies were not taken from the water to lie before us here.⁷ That’s why it is necessary to remember these men and to praise them always, for it was because of their excellence that we were victorious, not alone in that sea battle but also in the rest of the war. Indeed, it was because of them that our city earned the reputation for never being worn down by war, not even if the whole world assails us. And the reputation is a true one, for we were not subjugated by other people but by our own dissensions. We were undefeated by the others, and remain so to this day. We ourselves were the ones who defeated ourselves, we were indeed responsible for our own defeat.

πλεῖστα τρόπαια στήσαντες ὑπὲρ τῆς Λεοντίνων ἐλευθερίας, οἷς βοηθοῦντες διὰ τοὺς ὅρκους ἔπλευσαν εἰς ἐκείνους τοὺς τόπους, διὰ δὲ μῆκος τοῦ πλοῦ εἰς ἀπορίαν τῆς πόλεως καταστάσης καὶ οὐ δυναμένης

αὐτοῖς ὑπηρετεῖν, τούτῳ ἀπειπόντες ἐδυστύχησαν· ὧν οἱ ἐχθροὶ καὶ προσπολεμήσαντες πλείω ἔπαινον ἔχουσι σωφροσύνης καὶ ἀρετῆς ἢ τῶν ἄλλων οἱ φίλοι· πολλοὶ δ' ἐν ταῖς ναυμαχίαις ταῖς καθ' Ἑλλήσποντον, μιᾷ μὲν ἡμέρᾳ πάσας τὰς τῶν πολεμίων ἐλόντες ναῦς, πολλὰς δὲ καὶ ἄλλας νικήσαντες· ὃ δ' εἶπον δεινὸν καὶ ἀνέλπιστον τοῦ πολέμου γενέσθαι, τότε λέγω τὸ εἰς τοσοῦτον φιλονικίας ἐλθεῖν πρὸς τὴν πόλιν τοὺς ἄλλους Ἑλληνας, ὥστε τολμῆσαι τῷ ἐχθίστῳ ἐπικηρυκεύσασθαι βασιλεῖ, ὃν κοινῇ ἐξέβαλον μεθ' ἡμῶν, ἰδίᾳ τοῦτον πάλιν ἐπάγεσθαι, βάρβαρον ἐφ' Ἑλληνας, καὶ συναθροῖσαι ἐπὶ τὴν πόλιν πάντας Ἑλληνάς τε καὶ βαρβάρους. οὗ δὴ καὶ ἐκφανὴς ἐγένετο ἡ τῆς πόλεως ῥώμη τε καὶ ἀρετή. οἰομένων γὰρ ἤδη αὐτὴν καταπεπολεμῆσθαι καὶ ἀπειλημμένων ἐν Μυτιλήνῃ τῶν νεῶν, βοηθήσαντες ἐξήκοντα ναυσίν, αὐτοὶ ἐμβάντες εἰς τὰς ναῦς, καὶ ἄνδρες γενόμενοι ὁμολογουμένως ἄριστοι, νικήσαντες μὲν τοὺς πολεμίους, λυσάμενοι δὲ τοὺς φίλους, ἀναξίου τύχης τυχόντες, οὐκ ἀναιρεθέντες ἐκ τῆς θαλάττης κεῖνται ἐνθάδε. ὧν χρὴ αἰεὶ μεμνησθαι τε καὶ ἐπαινεῖν· τῇ μὲν γὰρ ἐκείνων ἀρετῇ ἐνικήσαμεν οὐ μόνον τὴν τότε ναυμαχίαν, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὸν ἄλλον πόλεμον· δόξαν γὰρ δι' αὐτοὺς ἡ πόλις ἔσχεν μή ποτ' ἂν καταπολεμηθῇαι μηδ' ὑπὸ πάντων ἀνθρώπων—καὶ ἀληθῆ ἔδοξεν—τῇ δὲ ἡμετέρᾳ αὐτῶν διαφορᾷ ἐκρατήθημεν, οὐχ ὑπὸ τῶν ἄλλων· ἀήττητοι γὰρ ἔτι καὶ νῦν ὑπὸ γε ἐκείνων ἐσμέν, ἡμεῖς δὲ αὐτοὶ ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς καὶ ἐνικήσαμεν καὶ ἡττήθημεν. μετὰ δὲ ταῦτα

243e

S: “After all this, when calm had returned and we were at peace with the others, a civil war was fought,⁸ but in such a way that if strife is indeed the fate of humanity, no one would pray that his own city might suffer this disease in any other way. So readily and familiarly did the citizens of the Piraeus and the mother city consort with one another and, contrary to expectations, with the other Greeks too, so naturally did they settle the war against the forces at Eleusis, that the only explanation for all this is their genuine kinship, producing firm friendship and unity in practice, not in mere words. What’s needed then is to remember those who died at one another’s hands in this war,

and to reconcile them through prayers and sacrifices such as these, praying to those who now have power over them, since we too have been reconciled. For it was not through evil that we set upon one another, nor through enmity, but through misfortune. To this do we, the living, bear witness ourselves. For we, being of the same stock as those men, are forgiving towards one another for what we did and what we suffered.

ἡσυχίας γενομένης καὶ εἰρήνης πρὸς τοὺς ἄλλους, ὁ οἰκεῖος ἡμῖν πόλεμος οὕτως ἐπολεμήθη, ὥστε εἴπερ εἰμαρμένον εἶη ἀνθρώποις στασιάσαι, μὴ ἂν ἄλλως εὖξασθαι μηδένα πόλιν ἑαυτοῦ νοσῆσαι. ΣΩ. ἔκ τε γὰρ τοῦ Πειραιῶς καὶ τοῦ ἄστεως ὡς ἀσμένως καὶ οἰκείως ἀλλήλοις συνέμειξαν οἱ πολῖται καὶ παρ' ἐλπίδα τοῖς ἄλλοις Ἑλλήσι, τὸν τε πρὸς τοὺς Ἑλευσῖνι πόλεμον ὡς μετρίως ἔθεντο· καὶ τούτων ἀπάντων οὐδὲν ἄλλ' αἴτιον ἢ ἡ τῷ ὄντι συγγένεια, φιλίαν βέβαιον καὶ ὁμόφυλον οὐ λόγῳ ἀλλ' ἔργῳ παρεχομένη. χρὴ δὲ καὶ τῶν ἐν τούτῳ τῷ πολέμῳ τελευτησάντων ὑπ' ἀλλήλων μνείαν ἔχειν καὶ διαλλάττειν αὐτοὺς ᾧ δυνάμεθα, εὐχαῖς καὶ θυσίαις, ἐν τοῖς τοιοῖσδε, τοῖς κρατοῦσιν αὐτῶν εὐχομένους, ἐπειδὴ καὶ ἡμεῖς διηλλάγμεθα. οὐ γὰρ κακία ἀλλήλων ἦψαντο οὐδ' ἔχθρα

244b

S: “After this there was complete peace among us, the city remained quiet, we were forgiving towards the non-Greeks, because although they had suffered badly at our hands, they had nevertheless put up a decent defence. But we were angry with our fellow Greeks, remembering how, despite the good we had done them, they showed their gratitude by aligning with the non-Greeks and depriving us of the very ships that had once saved even themselves, and by dismantling our walls, the very walls we sacrificed to save their walls from falling.⁹ Our city came to the view that it would no longer defend other Greek cities when threatened with enslavement, either by Greeks or by non-Greeks, and we stood by that decision. Now, such being our thinking, the Spartans decided that since we, the protectors

of freedom, had fallen, now was their opportunity to enslave the others, and they set about doing just that.

ἀλλὰ δυστυχία. μάρτυρες δὲ ἡμεῖς αὐτοὶ ἐσμεν τούτων οἱ ζῶντες· οἱ αὐτοὶ γὰρ ὄντες ἐκείνοις γένει συγγνώμην ἀλλήλοις ἔχομεν ὣν τ' ἐποιήσαμεν ὣν τ' ἐπάθομεν. μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο παντελῶς εἰρήνης ἡμῖν γενομένης, ἡσυχίαν ἤγεν ἡ πόλις, τοῖς μὲν βαρβάροις συγγιγνώσκουσα, ὅτι παθόντες ὑπ' αὐτῆς κακῶς ἱκανῶς οὐκ ἐνδεῶς ἡμύναντο, τοῖς δὲ Ἑλλήσιν ἀγανακτοῦσα, μεμνημένη ὡς εὖ παθόντες ὑπ' αὐτῆς οἶαν χάριν ἀπέδωσαν, κοινωσάμενοι τοῖς βαρβάροις, τάς τε ναῦς περιελόμενοι αἶ ποτ' ἐκείνους ἔσωσαν, καὶ τεῖχη καθελόντες ἀνθ' ὧν ἡμεῖς τὰκείνων ἐκωλύσαμεν πεσεῖν· διανοουμένη δὲ ἡ πόλις μὴ ἂν ἔτι ἀμῦναι μήτε Ἑλλήσι πρὸς ἀλλήλων δουλουμένοις μήτε ὑπὸ βαρβάρων, οὕτως ᾧκει. ἡμῶν οὖν ἐν τοιαύτῃ διανοίᾳ ὄντων ἡγησάμενοι Λακεδαιμόνιοι τοὺς μὲν τῆς ἐλευθερίας ἐπικούρους πεπτωκέναι ἡμᾶς, σφέτερον δὲ ἤδη

244d

S: “But why prolong this? For the next events did not happen to people of old in times long past. Indeed, we ourselves know that the foremost peoples among the Greeks – the Boeotians, Argives and Corinthians – being terror-struck, came to need our city, and miraculously, so too did the King, who was so worried that he turned for salvation to no other city than our city, which he had been so eager to destroy. What’s more, if anyone were to level a justifiable accusation against this city, they could rightly accuse it only of being excessively compassionate and of favouring the weak. And, indeed, it was unable to hold out and stand by its decision not to assist any of those Greeks who had wronged it, if any of them were being enslaved. Rather, it relented, came to their aid, and by assisting them it freed the Greeks from slavery so that they were free until such time as they enslaved one another once more. But it dared not render assistance to the King for fear of bringing shame upon the victory trophies raised at Marathon, Salamis and Plateia. Rather, by allowing only exiles and volunteers to provide assistance, it undoubtedly saved him. Having refortified its

walls and rebuilt its navy, it took on the struggle since it was necessary to do so, and fought for the Parians against the Spartans.

ἔργον εἶναι καταδουλοῦσθαι τοὺς ἄλλους, ταῦτ' ἔπραττον. καὶ μὴκύνειν μὲν τί δεῖ; οὐ γὰρ πάλα οὐδὲ παλαιῶν ἀνθρώπων γεγονότα λέγοιμ' ἂν τὰ μετὰ ταῦτα· αὐτοὶ γὰρ ἴσμεν ὥς ἐκπεπληγμένοι ἀφίκοντο εἰς χρεῖαν τῆς πόλεως τῶν τε Ἑλλήνων οἱ πρῶτοι, Ἀργεῖοι καὶ Βοιωτοὶ καὶ Κορίνθιοι, καὶ τό γε θειότατον πάντων, τὸ καὶ βασιλέα εἰς τοῦτο ἀπορίας ἀφικέσθαι, ὥστε περιστῆναι αὐτῷ μηδαμόθεν ἄλλοθεν τὴν σωτηρίαν γενέσθαι ἀλλ' ἢ ἐκ ταύτης τῆς πόλεως, ἣν προθύμως ἀπώλλυ. καὶ δὴ καὶ εἴ τις βούλοιο τῆς πόλεως κατηγορῆσαι δικαίως, τοῦτ' ἂν μόνον λέγων ὀρθῶς ἂν κατηγοροῖ, ὥς αἰεὶ λίαν φιλοικτίρμων ἐστὶ καὶ τοῦ ἥττονος θεραπὶς. ΣΩ. καὶ δὴ καὶ ἐν τῷ τότε χρόνῳ οὐχ οἷα τε ἐγένετο καρτερῆσαι οὐδὲ διαφυλάξαι ἃ ἐδέδοκτο αὐτῇ, τὸ μηδενὶ δουλουμένῳ βοηθεῖν τῶν σφᾶς ἀδικησάντων, ἀλλὰ ἐκάμφθη καὶ ἐβοήθησεν, καὶ τοὺς μὲν Ἑλληνας αὐτῇ βοηθήσασα ἀπελύσατο δουλείας, ὥστ' ἐλευθέρους εἶναι μέχρι οὗ πάλιν αὐτοὶ αὐτοὺς κατεδουλώσαντο, βασιλεῖ δὲ αὐτῇ μὲν οὐκ ἐτόλμησεν βοηθῆσαι, αἰσχυνομένη τὰ τρόπαια τὰ τε Μαραθῶνι καὶ Σαλαμῖνι καὶ Πλαταιαῖς, φυγάδας δὲ καὶ ἐθέλοντάς ἑάσασα μόνον βοηθῆσαι ὁμολογουμένως ἔσωσεν. τειχισαμένην δὲ καὶ ναυπηγησαμένην,

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S: “But the King was afraid of our city because he had seen the Spartans give up on naval warfare against us. So, because he wanted to withdraw, he demanded, if he was to fight alongside us and the other allies, that we surrender the mainland Greeks whom the Spartans had previously given over to him. He assumed we would be unwilling to grant his request, thus giving him an excuse to withdraw from the alliance. In the case of the others he was mistaken, for they were willing to hand them over to him, and so the Corinthians, Argives, Boeotians, and the other allies swore a covenant to hand over the mainland Greeks if the King would give them money. But we alone dared not hand them over or swear the oath. This shows the nobility of our city and how free, resolute and sound it is, with a natural hatred

of the non-Greeks because we are purely Greek, devoid of non-Greek admixture. Indeed, there dwell among us none of the offspring of Pelops, nor of Cadmus or Aegyptus, nor of Danaus, nor of the various other peoples who are non-Greeks by nature but Greeks by convention. But we live as actual Greeks, not half-non-Greeks, and so our city is imbued with a pure hatred of this alien nature. Nevertheless, we stood alone once more because of our reluctance to perform a disgraceful and unholy deed by handing Greeks over to non-Greeks. Now, despite finding ourselves in the same predicament as led to our subjugation previously, we settled the conflict, with God's help, on better terms than we did before. For we concluded the war retaining our walls, our ships, and our own colonies, so glad too were our enemies to be quit of the conflict. Yet we lost good men in that war, as they dealt with the difficult terrain at Corinth and with treachery at Lechaëum. Good too were the men who freed the King and drove the Spartans from our waters. I am reminding you of them and it is fitting that you too should praise and glorify such men as these.

ἐκδεξαμένη τὸν πόλεμον, ἐπειδὴ ἡναγκάσθη πολεμεῖν, ὑπὲρ Παρίων ἐπολέμει Λακεδαιμονίοις. φοβηθεῖς δὲ βασιλεὺς τὴν πόλιν, ἐπειδὴ ἑώρα Λακεδαιμονίους τῷ κατὰ θάλατταν πολέμῳ ἀπαγορεύοντας, ἀποστῆναι βουλόμενος ἐξήτει τοὺς Ἕλληνας τοὺς ἐν τῇ ἡπείρῳ, οὕσπερ πρότερον Λακεδαιμόνιοι αὐτῷ ἐξέδοσαν, εἰ μέλλοι συμμαχήσειν ἡμῖν τε καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις συμμαχοῖς, ἡγούμενος οὐκ ἐθελήσειν, ἵν' αὐτῷ πρόφασις εἴη τῆς ἀποστάσεως. καὶ τῶν μὲν ἄλλων συμμαχῶν ἐψεύσθη ἡθέλησαν γὰρ αὐτῷ ἐκδιδόναι καὶ συνέθεντο καὶ ὤμοσαν Κορίνθιοι καὶ Ἀργεῖοι καὶ Βοιωτοὶ καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι σύμμαχοι, εἰ μέλλοι χρήματα παρέξειν, ἐκδώσειν τοὺς ἐν τῇ ἡπείρῳ Ἕλληνας· μόνοι δὲ ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἐτολμήσαμεν οὔτε ἐκδοῦναι οὔτε ὁμόσαι. οὕτω δὴ τοι τό γε τῆς πόλεως γενναῖον καὶ ἐλευθερον βέβαιόν τε καὶ ὑγιές ἐστιν καὶ φύσει μισοβάρβαρον, διὰ τὸ εἰλικρινῶς εἶναι Ἕλληνας καὶ ἀμιγεῖς βαρβάρων. οὐ γὰρ Πέλοπες οὐδὲ Κάδοι οὐδὲ Αἴγυπτοί τε καὶ Δαναοὶ οὐδὲ ἄλλοι πολλοὶ φύσει μὲν βάρβαροι ὄντες, νόμῳ δὲ Ἕλληνες, συνοικοῦσιν ἡμῖν, ἀλλ' αὐτοὶ Ἕλληνες, οὐ μειζοβάρβαροι οἰκοῦμεν, ὅθεν καθαρὸν τὸ μῖσος ἐντέτηκε

τῇ πόλει τῆς ἀλλοτρίας φύσεως. ὅμως δ' οὖν ἐμονώθημεν πάλιν διὰ τὸ μὴ ἐθέλιν αἰσχρὸν καὶ ἀνόσιον ἔργον ἐργάσασθαι Ἑλλήνας βαρβάροις ἐκδόντες. ἐλθόντες οὖν εἰς ταῦτα ἐξ ὧν καὶ τὸ πρότερον κατεπολεμήθημεν, σὺν θεῷ ἄμεινον ἢ τότε ἐθέμεθα τὸν πόλεμον· καὶ γὰρ ναῦς καὶ τεῖχη ἔχοντες καὶ τὰς ἡμετέρας αὐτῶν ἀποικίας ἀπηλλάγημεν τοῦ πολέμου οὕτως, ὥστ' ἀγαπητῶς ἀπηλλάττοντο καὶ οἱ πολέμιοι. ΣΩ. ἀνδρῶν μέντοι ἀγαθῶν καὶ ἐν τούτῳ τῷ πολέμῳ ἐστερήθημεν, τῶν τε ἐν Κορίνθῳ χρησαμένων δυσχωρίᾳ καὶ ἐν Λεχαίῳ

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S: “These, indeed, were the achievements of those men who now lie here, and of the others who died for this city. Many noble deeds have been described, and many more deeds, even more noble than these, remain. Indeed, many days and nights would prove insufficient for anyone who set about recounting all of them. So what is needed is to remember these men, and every one of us should exhort their descendants, as if on the battlefield, never to withdraw from the struggle by yielding to cowardice. And so, O sons of good men, I myself am calling upon you now and hereafter, and wherever I encounter you I shall remind and exhort you to set your hearts upon being the very best of men. At the moment it is only right that I tell you what your fathers, when they were about to face danger, directed us to proclaim to those who are always left behind, in case anything was to happen to them. I will tell you what I heard from the men themselves, and also, based upon what they said then, the sort of things they might like to say to you now if they were able to do so. But you must imagine that you are hearing whatever I proclaim directly from the men themselves. What they said was this:

προδοσίᾳ· ἀγαθοὶ δὲ καὶ οἱ βασιλεῖα ἐλευθερώσαντες καὶ ἐκβαλόντες ἐκ τῆς θαλάττης Λακεδαιμονίους ὧν ἐγὼ μὲν ὑμᾶς ἀναμιμνήσκω, ὑμᾶς δὲ πρέπει συνεπαινεῖν τε καὶ κοσμεῖν τοιούτους ἄνδρας. καὶ τὰ μὲν δὴ ἔργα ταῦτα τῶν ἀνδρῶν τῶν ἐνθάδε κειμένων καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὅσοι ὑπὲρ τῆς πόλεως τετελευτήκασι, πολλὰ μὲν τὰ εἰρημένα καὶ καλὰ, πολὺ δ' ἔτι πλείω καὶ καλλίω τὰ ὑπολειπόμενα· πολλοὶ γὰρ ἂν ἡμέραι καὶ

νύκτες οὐχ ἱκαναὶ γένοιντο τῷ τὰ πάντα μέλλοντι περαίνειν. τούτων οὖν χρή μεμνημένους τοῖς τούτων ἐκγόνοις πάντ' ἄνδρα παρακελεύεσθαι, ὥσπερ ἐν πολέμῳ, μὴ λείπειν τὴν τάξιν τὴν τῶν προγόνων μηδ' εἰς τοῦπίσω ἀναχωρεῖν εἴκοντας κάκῃ. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν καὶ αὐτός, ὃ παῖδες ἀνδρῶν ἀγαθῶν, νῦν τε παρακελύομαι καὶ ἐν τῷ λοιπῷ χρόνῳ, ὅπου ἂν τῷ ἐντυγχάνω ὑμῶν, καὶ ἀναμνήσω καὶ διακελεύσομαι προθυμεῖσθαι εἶναι ὡς ἀρίστους· ἐν δὲ τῷ παρόντι δίκαιός εἰμι εἰπεῖν ἃ οἱ πατέρες ἡμῖν ἐπέσκηπτον ἀπαγγέλλειν τοῖς ἀεὶ λειπομένοις, εἴ τι πάσχοιεν, ἥνίκα κινδυνεύσειεν ἔμελλον. φράσω δὲ ὑμῖν ἃ τε αὐτῶν ἤκουσα ἐκείνων καὶ οἷα νῦν ἡδέως ἂν εἶποιεν ὑμῖν λαβόντες δύναμιν, τεκμαιρόμενος ἐξ ὧν τότε ἔλεγον. ἀλλὰ νομίζειν χρή αὐτῶν ἀκούειν ἐκείνων ἃ ἂν ἀπαγγέλλω· ἔλεγον δὲ τάδε—

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S: “Sons, the present situation itself makes it plain that you were born of good fathers. We who had the opportunity to live without honour, choose rather to die an honourable death before we would draw criticism down upon yourselves and your successors, and bring shame upon our own fathers and our entire ancestry. Indeed, we believe that life is not worth living for anyone who brings shame upon his own, and that such a person is a friend neither of the gods nor of humanity, neither during his life on earth nor beneath the earth in death. So you should remember our words, and if you practise anything else, practise it along with excellence, knowing that in the absence of this all possessions and activities are shameful and base. For neither does wealth bring distinction to someone who has acquired it with cowardice, for such a person is wealthy because of something else and not because of himself, nor does beauty and strength of body appear fitting when these dwell within a base coward; they are not fitting, they make their possessor conspicuous, and they highlight his cowardice. And any knowledge that is sundered from justice and from excellence in general proves to be mere chicanery and not wisdom.

ὃ παῖδες, ὅτι μὲν ἔστε πατέρων ἀγαθῶν, αὐτὸ μηνύει τὸ νῦν παρόν· ἡμῖν δὲ ἐξὸν ζῆν μὴ καλῶς, καλῶς αἰρούμεθα μᾶλλον τελευτᾶν, πρὶν

ὕμᾱς τε καὶ τοὺς ἔπειτα εἰς ὄνειδῃ καταστήσαι καὶ πρὶν τοὺς ἡμετέρους πατέρας καὶ πᾶν τὸ πρόσθεν γένος αἰσχῦναι, ἡγούμενοι τῷ τοὺς αὐτοῦ αἰσχύναντι ἀβίωτον εἶναι, καὶ τῷ τοιοῦτῳ οὔτε τινὰ ἀνθρώπων οὔτε θεῶν φίλον εἶναι οὔτ' ἐπὶ γῆς οὔθ' ὑπὸ γῆς τελευτήσαντι. χρή οὖν μεμνημένους τῶν ἡμετέρων λόγων, ἐάν τι καὶ ἄλλο

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S: “For all these reasons you should strive in every way, first and last, by all means, to be possessed of the utmost zeal, particularly to exceed ourselves and our predecessors in glory. But mark my words, if you fall short and we triumph over you in excellence, our victory will be a source of shame, but if we lose out to you, our defeat will bring happiness. And we would best be defeated and you would triumph if you were prepared not to trade upon the reputation of your ancestors, nor to waste it, realising that for a man who thinks he amounts to something, there is nothing more disgraceful than to secure honour for himself, not in his own right, but through the reputation of his ancestors. For honours belonging to ancestors are a noble and exalted treasure to the descendants. But to use up a treasury of wealth and honours, and bequeath none to your children because of a deficiency of wealth and reputation of your own, is base and unmanly. And if you practise these precepts, you will join us as friends meeting friends whenever fate and destiny carry you here. But if you heed them not and play the coward, no one here will receive you graciously. So let these words be spoken to our sons.

ἀσκήτε, ἀσκεῖν μετ' ἀρετῆς, εἰδότας ὅτι τούτου λειπόμενα πάντα καὶ κτήματα καὶ ἐπιτηδεύματα αἰσχρὰ καὶ κακά. οὔτε γὰρ πλοῦτος κάλλος φέρει τῷ κεκτημένῳ μετ' ἀνανδρίας— ἄλλω γὰρ ὁ τοιοῦτος πλουτεῖ καὶ οὐχ' ἑαυτῷ—οὔτε σώματος κάλλος καὶ ἰσχύς δειλῷ καὶ κακῷ συνοικοῦντα πρέποντα φαίνεται ἀλλ' ἀπρεπῇ, καὶ ἐπιφανέστερον ποιεῖ τὸν ἔχοντα καὶ ἐκφαίνει τὴν δειλίαν. ΣΩ. πᾶσά τε ἐπιστήμη χωριζομένη δικαιοσύνης καὶ τῆς ἄλλης ἀρετῆς πανουργία, οὐ σοφία φαίνεται. ὦν ἔνεκα καὶ πρῶτον καὶ ὕστατον καὶ διὰ παντὸς πᾶσαν πάντως προθυμίαν πειρᾶσθε ἔχειν ὅπως μάλιστα μὲν υπερβαλεῖσθε καὶ ἡμᾶς καὶ τοὺς

πρόσθεν εὐκλείῃ· εἰ δὲ μή, ἵστε ὡς ἡμῖν, ἂν μὲν νικῶμεν ὑμᾶς ἀρετῇ, ἡ νίκη αἰσχύνην φέρει, ἡ δὲ ἥττα, ἔαν ἡττώμεθα, εὐδαιμονίαν. μάλιστα δ' ἂν νικώμεθα καὶ ὑμεῖς νικῶητε, εἰ παρασκευάσασθε τῇ τῶν προγόνων δόξῃ μὴ καταχρησόμενοι μηδ' ἀναλώσοντες αὐτήν, γνόντες ὅτι ἀνδρὶ οἰομένῳ τί εἶναι οὐκ ἔστιν αἴσχιον οὐδὲν ἢ παρέχειν ἑαυτὸν τιμώμενον μὴ δι' ἑαυτὸν ἀλλὰ διὰ δόξαν προγόνων. εἶναι μὲν γὰρ τιμὰς γονέων ἐκγόνοις καλὸς θησαυρὸς καὶ μεγαλοπρεπής· χρῆσθαι δὲ καὶ χρημάτων καὶ τιμῶν θησαυρῷ, καὶ μὴ τοῖς ἐκγόνοις παραδιδόναι, αἰσχρὸν καὶ ἄνδρον, ἀπορίᾳ ἰδίων αὐτοῦ κτημάτων τε καὶ εὐδοξίων.

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S: “Those of us who have fathers and mothers still living should encourage them to bear the misfortune, should it befall them, as easily as possible, and we should not join in their lamentations, for they will need no additional cause for sorrow. The present misfortune will indeed be enough to provide that. We should rather, with soothing and healing words, remind them that in matters of the greatest importance, their prayers have already been heard by the gods. For they did not pray for their sons to become immortal, but for them to become good and renowned, and they have already succeeded in these great achievements. For a mortal man, everything in his own life does not easily turn out according to plan. And if they bear the misfortunes courageously, they shall be regarded, in truth, as fathers of brave sons, who are just as brave themselves. But if they yield to unmanliness, they shall create the suspicion either that they are not our fathers, or that the people who praise us have been deceived. Neither option is acceptable. They should, rather, praise us most of all with their deeds, thus proving themselves, plainly and truly, to be the fathers of men who are indeed men. For the old saying ‘nothing in excess’ seems to be a good one and well worth quoting. That man is best equipped for life who relies upon himself for everything, or almost everything; that leads to happiness, and does not depend upon other people being compelled, as a consequence, to fare either well or badly in his own affairs as others’ misfortunes fluctuate. This is the sound-minded man,

the courageous man, the wise man. Such a man, as wealth and children come and go, will best abide by this maxim, and will, because of his self-reliance, be seen neither rejoicing nor grieving to excess.

καὶ ἐὰν μὲν ταῦτα ἐπιτηδεύσητε, φίλοι παρὰ φίλους ἡμᾶς ἀφίξεσθε, ὅταν ὑμᾶς ἡ προσήκουσα μοῖρα κομίσῃ· ἀμελήσαντας δὲ ὑμᾶς καὶ κακισθέντας οὐδεὶς εὐμενῶς ὑποδέξεται. τοῖς μὲν οὖν παισὶ ταῦτ' εἰρήσθω. πατέρας δὲ ἡμῶν, οἷς εἰσὶ, καὶ μητέρας ἀεὶ χρή παραμυθεῖσθαι ὥς ῥᾶστα φέρειν τὴν συμφορὰν, ἐὰν ἄρα συμβῇ γενέσθαι, καὶ μὴ συνοδύρεσθαι—οὐ γὰρ τοῦ λυπήσοντος προσδεήσονται· ἱκανὴ γὰρ ἔσται καὶ ἡ γενομένη τύχη τοῦτο πορίζειν—ἀλλ' ἰωμένους καὶ πραῦνοντας ἀναμνησκείν αὐτοὺς ὅτι ὧν ἡὔχοντο τὰ μέγιστα αὐτοῖς οἱ θεοὶ ἐπήκοοι γεγόνασιν. οὐ γὰρ ἀθανάτους σφίσι παῖδας ἡὔχοντο γενέσθαι ἀλλ' ἀγαθοὺς καὶ εὐκλεεῖς, ὧν ἔτυχον, μεγίστων ἀγαθῶν ὄντων· πάντα δὲ οὐ ῥάδιον θνητῷ ἀνδρὶ κατὰ νοῦν ἐν τῷ ἑαυτοῦ βίῳ ἐκβαίνειν. καὶ φέροντες μὲν ἀνδρείως τὰς συμφορὰς δόξουσι τῷ ὄντι ἀνδρείων παίδων πατέρες εἶναι καὶ αὐτοὶ τοιοῦτοι, ὑπεῖκοντες δὲ ὑποψίαν παρέξουσιν ἢ μὴ ἡμέτεροι εἶναι ἢ ἡμῶν τοὺς ἐπαινοῦντας καταψεύδεσθαι· χρή δὲ οὐδέτερα τούτων, ἀλλ' ἐκείνους μάλιστα ἡμῶν ἐπαινέτας εἶναι ἔργω, παρέχοντας αὐτοὺς φαινομένους τῷ ὄντι πατέρας ὄντας ἄνδρας ἀνδρῶν. πάλαι γὰρ δὴ τὸ μηδὲν ἄγαν λεγόμενον καλῶς δοκεῖ λέγεσθαι· τῷ γὰρ ὄντι εὖ λέγεται. ΣΩ. ὅτῳ γὰρ ἀνδρὶ εἰς ἑαυτὸν ἀνήρτηται πάντα τὰ πρὸς εὐδαιμονίαν φέροντα ἢ ἐγγὺς τούτου, καὶ μὴ ἐν ἄλλοις ἀνθρώποις αἰωρεῖται ἐξ ὧν ἢ εὖ ἢ κακῶς πραξάντων πλανᾶσθαι ἠνάγκασται καὶ τὰ ἐκείνου, τούτῳ ἄριστα παρεσκευάσται ζῆν, οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ σώφρων καὶ οὗτος ὁ ἀνδρεῖος καὶ φρόνιμος· οὗτος γιγνομένων χρημάτων καὶ παίδων καὶ διαφθειρομένων μάλιστα πείσεται τῇ παροιμίᾳ· οὔτε γὰρ χαίρων οὔτε λυπούμενος ἄγαν φανήσεται διὰ τὸ αὐτῷ πεποιθέναι. τοιούτους

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S: “These are the sort of people we ask our own kinfolk to be, such is our wish and our declaration, and we are now presenting ourselves as such, devoid of tribulation or trepidation, even if we should meet with death in the present struggle. So we implore our fathers and mothers

to live out their lives with this same attitude, knowing that they will not really please us by singing dirges and lamenting over us. Rather, if the dead have any awareness of the living, they would greatly displease us by behaving in this way, by debasing themselves and bearing their sorrows so heavily. But by bearing them lightly and in due measure, they would greatly delight us. For our lives will, by then, have come to an end in the most noble death that humans can meet with, so it is more important to glorify these than to lament them. But by caring for our wives and children, and nurturing them, thus turning their attention to this world, they might best forget their misfortune and live a life that is better, more upright, and more pleasing to ourselves. That is a sufficient message to relay from us to our kindred, and we could exhort the city to look after our fathers and sons for us, educating the one systematically, while supporting the others in old age as they deserve. But we already know that the city will care adequately for these people, even without our exhortation.'

δὲ ἡμεῖς γε ἀξιούμεν καὶ τοὺς ἡμετέρους εἶναι καὶ βουλόμεθα καὶ φαμέν, καὶ ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς νῦν παρέχομεν τοιούτους, οὐκ ἀγανακτοῦντας οὐδὲ φοβούμενους ἄγαν εἰ δεῖ τελευτᾶν ἐν τῷ παρόντι. δεόμεθα δὴ καὶ πατέρων καὶ μητέρων τῇ αὐτῇ ταύτῃ διανοίᾳ χρωμένους τὸν ἐπίλοιπον βίον διάγειν, καὶ εἰδέναι ὅτι οὐ θρηνοῦντες οὐδὲ ὀλοφυρόμενοι ἡμᾶς ἡμῖν μάλιστα χαριῶνται, ἀλλ' εἴ τις ἔστι τοῖς τετελευτηκόσιν αἴσθησις τῶν ζώντων, οὕτως ἀχάριστοι εἶεν ἂν μάλιστα, ἑαυτοὺς τε κακοῦντες καὶ βαρέως φέροντες τὰς συμφοράς· κούφως δὲ καὶ μετρίως μάλιστ' ἂν χαρίζοιντο. τὰ μὲν γὰρ ἡμέτερα τελευτὴν ἤδη ἔξει ἥπερ καλλίστη γίγνεται ἀνθρώποις, ὥστε πρέπει αὐτὰ μᾶλλον κοσμεῖν ἢ θρηνεῖν· γυναικῶν δὲ τῶν ἡμετέρων καὶ παίδων ἐπιμελούμενοι καὶ τρέφοντες καὶ ἐνταῦθα τὸν νοῦν τρέποντες τῆς τε τύχης μάλιστ' ἂν εἶεν ἐν λήθῃ καὶ ζῶεν κάλλιον καὶ ὀρθότερον καὶ ἡμῖν προσφιλέστερον. ταῦτα δὴ ἱκανὰ τοῖς ἡμετέροις παρ' ἡμῶν ἀγγέλλειν· τῇ δὲ πόλει παρακελευοίμεθ' ἂν ὅπως ἡμῖν καὶ πατέρων καὶ ὑέων ἐπιμελήσονται, τοὺς μὲν παιδεύοντες κοσμίως, τοὺς δὲ γηροτροφοῦντες ἀξίως· νῦν δὲ

ἴσμεν ὅτι καὶ ἐὰν μὴ ἡμεῖς παρακελευώμεθα, ἱκανῶς ἐπιμελήσεται. ταῦτα οὖν, ὦ παῖδες καὶ γονῆς τῶν τελευτησάντων, ἐκεῖνοί

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S: “These are the words, O children and parents of the fallen, which they directed us to relay and which I am doing my eager best to relay. And I myself, on their behalf, ask their children to imitate these people and ask their parents to be optimistic about themselves because we, both individually and collectively, shall support you in your old age and care for you whenever any of us encounters any of you. And in the case of the city, you know, I presume, the care it exercises, and that it does so by instituting laws concerning the children and forebears of those who have died in war, and that, more than for any other citizens, the very highest authority is commanded to guard against any injustice being done to the fathers or mothers of such people. The city assists in raising their children, being eager that their status as orphans is concealed as much as possible. While they are yet children, it installs itself in the role of father, and once they have come to manhood it sends them forth on their own worldly duties arrayed in battle armour, showing them reminders of their fathers’ pursuits, giving them the instruments of their paternal excellence, and at the same time, for the sake of the omen, reminding them to begin the journey back to the ancestral hearth, there to rule with power, adorned in full armour.¹⁰ The city never fails to honour these fallen men. Every year it performs the traditional rites publicly for all, the very ones that are conducted by each citizen in private. And what’s more, it has instituted athletic and equestrian competitions, and contests in music of all sorts. Indeed, it stands, in general, in the position of son and heir to the departed, acting as a father of their sons and as a guardian of their parents, exercising every care for all of them always. Ponder all this and bear the misfortune more gently, for you will in this way be most pleasing to the living and the dead and will most easily serve others and yourselves. Now that you and all the

others have publicly lamented the departed according to custom, you should go on your way.”

τε ἐπέσκηπτον ἡμῖν ἀπαγγέλλειν, καὶ ἐγὼ ὡς δύναμαι προθυμότατα ἀπαγγέλλω· καὶ αὐτὸς δέομαι ὑπὲρ ἐκείνων, τῶν μὲν μιμεῖσθαι τοὺς αὐτῶν, τῶν δὲ θαρρεῖν ὑπὲρ αὐτῶν, ὡς ἡμῶν καὶ ἰδίᾳ καὶ δημοσίᾳ γηροτροφησόντων ὑμᾶς καὶ ἐπιμελησομένων, ὅπου ἂν ἕκαστος ἐκάστω ἐντυχάνῃ ὀφροῦν τῶν ἐκείνων. ΣΩ. τῆς δὲ πόλεως ἵστε που καὶ αὐτοὶ τὴν ἐπιμέλειαν, ὅτι νόμους θεμένη περὶ τοὺς τῶν ἐν τῷ πολέμῳ τελευτησάντων παῖδᾶς τε καὶ γεννήτορας ἐπιμελεῖται, καὶ διαφερόντως τῶν ἄλλων πολιτῶν προστέτακται φυλάττειν ἀρχὴ ἥπερ μεγίστη ἐστίν, ὅπως ἂν οἱ τούτων μὴ ἀδικῶνται πατέρες τε καὶ μητέρες· τοὺς δὲ παῖδας συνεκτρέφει αὐτῇ, προθυμουμένη ὅτι μάλιστ’ ἄδηλον αὐτοῖς τὴν ὀρφανίαν γενέσθαι, ἐν πατρὸς σχήματι καταστᾶσα αὐτοῖς αὐτὴ ἔτι τε παισὶν οὖσιν, καὶ ἐπειδὰν εἰς ἀνδρὸς τέλος ἴωσιν, ἀποπέμπει ἐπὶ τὰ σφέτερόν αὐτῶν πανοπλίᾳ κοσμήσασα, ἐνδεικνυμένη καὶ ἀναμνηνέσκουσα τὰ τοῦ πατρὸς ἐπιτηδεύματα ὄργανα τῆς πατρώας ἀρετῆς διδοῦσα, καὶ ἅμα οἰωνοῦ χάριν ἄρχεσθαι ἰέναι ἐπὶ τὴν πατρώαν ἐστίαν ἄρξοντα μετ’ ἰσχύος ὅπλοις κεκοσμημένον. αὐτοὺς δὲ τοὺς τελευτήσαντας τιμῶσα οὐδέποτε ἐκλείπει, καθ’ ἕκαστον ἐνιαυτὸν αὐτὴ τὰ νομιζόμενα ποιοῦσα κοινῇ πᾶσιν ἅπερ ἐκάστω ἰδίᾳ γίγνεται, πρὸς δὲ τούτοις ἀγῶνας γυμνικοὺς καὶ ἵππικοὺς τιθεῖσα καὶ μουσικῆς πάσης, καὶ ἀτεχνῶς τῶν μὲν τελευτησάντων ἐν κληρονόμου καὶ ὑέος

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S: There you have it, Menexenus, the speech of Aspasia of Miletus.

μοίρᾳ καθεστηκυῖα, τῶν δὲ ὑέων ἐν πατρός, γονέων δὲ τῶν τούτων ἐπιτρόπου, πᾶσαν πάντων παρὰ πάντα τὸν χρόνον ἐπιμέλειαν ποιουμένη. ὦν χρὴ ἐνθυμουμένους πρᾶότερον φέρειν τὴν συμφορὰν· τοῖς τε γὰρ τελευτήσασι καὶ τοῖς ζῶσιν οὕτως ἂν προσφιλέστατοι εἴτε καὶ ῥᾶστοι θεραπεύειν τε καὶ θεραπεύεσθαι. νῦν δὲ ἤδη ὑμεῖς τε καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι πάντες κοινῇ κατὰ τὸν νόμον τοὺς τετελευτηκότας ἀπολοφυράμενοι ἄπιτε.

MX: By Zeus, Socrates, Aspasia is remarkable according to you, if, being a woman, she is able to compose a speech of this sort.

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S: Well, if you don't believe me, come along with me and hear her speaking.

οὗτός σοι ὁ λόγος, ὃ Μενέξενε, Ἀσπασίας τῆς Μιλησίας ἐστίν. ΜΕΝ. νῆ Δία, ὃ Σώκρατες, μακαρίαν γε λέγεις τὴν Ἀσπασίαν, εἰ γυνὴ οὔσα τοιούτους λόγους οἷα τ' ἐστὶ συντιθέναι. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εἰ μὴ πιστεύεις, ἀκολουθεῖ μετ' ἐμοῦ, καὶ ἀκούσῃ αὐτῆς λεγούσης. ΜΕΝ. πολλάκις, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἐγὼ ἐντετύχηκα Ἀσπασίᾳ, καὶ οἶδα οἷα ἐστίν. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; οὐκ ἄγασαι αὐτὴν καὶ νῦν χάριν ἔχεις τοῦ λόγου αὐτῆς; ΜΕΝ. καὶ πολλήν γε, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἐγὼ χάριν ἔχω τούτου

MX: Socrates, I have come across Aspasia many times and I know the sort of woman she is.

S: Well then, don't you admire her and aren't you grateful to her now for the speech?

MX: Yes, Socrates, I am very grateful for this speech, to her or to the person, whoever it was, who relayed it to you. And for many reasons, I am grateful to the present speaker.

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S: Very well, but please don't denounce me to her so that I may, on another occasion, relay to you lots of beautiful political speeches of hers.

τοῦ λόγου ἐκείνη ἢ ἐκείνῳ ὅστις σοι ὁ εἰπὼν ἐστὶν αὐτόν· καὶ πρὸς γε ἄλλων πολλῶν χάριν ἔχω τῷ εἰπόντι. ΣΩ. εἴ ἂν ἔχοι· ἀλλ' ὅπως μου μὴ κατερεῖς, ἵνα καὶ αὐθὶς σοι πολλοὺς καὶ καλοὺς λόγους παρ' αὐτῆς πολιτικούς ἀπαγγέλλω. ΜΕΝ. θάρρει, οὐ κατερῶ· μόνον ἀπάγγελλε. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ ταῦτ' ἔσται.

MX: Rest assured I shan't denounce you. Just relay the speeches.

S: Yes, you will have your speeches.

Notes

¹ Lamprus was an accomplished lyre player. Antiphon of Rhamnous was the earliest of the ten Attic Orators, and is regarded as the founder of political rhetoric.

² This refers to the dispute between Athena and Poseidon over the sovereignty of Athens. The question at issue was whether the olive tree provided by Athena or the salt-water spring that Poseidon produced on the Acropolis was more valuable.

³ Eumolpus, leading the Eleusinians, was defeated by the Athenians under the legendary King Erechtheus at Eleusis. According to legend, when the Amazons laid siege to Athens they were repelled by Theseus, who, after leading the Athenians to Thebes, secured the return of the Argive dead following the battle of the Seven Against Thebes. The Thebans were referred to as Cadmeans due to the story of the city's founding by Cadmus. Eurystheus, who ruled a number of cities in Argos, pursued the sons of Heracles, who had retreated to Athens. When Eurystheus attempted to capture them, he was defeated by the Athenians.

⁴ These battles took place during the second Persian invasion of Greece under Xerxes.

⁵ The 'extensive war' referred to here is the first part of the Peloponnesian War.

⁶ The 'third war' referred to here is the second part of the Peloponnesian War.

⁷ Following the naval battle at Arginusae, the generals were severely criticised for failing to rescue the wounded and retrieve the bodies of the dead from the sea. Plato, *Apology* 32b ff.

⁸ This civil war was an attempt to topple the oligarchy of the Thirty Tyrants, which had gained power at the end of the Peloponnesian War, and restore the Athenian democracy. The civil war ended with the defeat of the Thirty at Eleusis.

⁹ This refers to the Persian invasion led by Xerxes when the Athenians abandoned their city, taking to the sea and eventually defeating the invading forces at the battle of Salamis.

¹⁰ There was a tradition that during the festival to Dionysus, the sons of soldiers who had died in battle were presented to the public dressed in full armour in a

ceremony that marked the transfer of property from father to son.